

have become so popular that, music CDs of these soundtracks were available in stores.

Semiotic functions

Game music helps in conveying emotional meaning, focusing the attention of player, identifying goals and objects. In many games, for example, the lesser enemies all have the same music, and beneficial items like gems or pieces of heart likewise all have the same or similar sounding cues. A crucial semiotic role of sound in games is the preparatory functions that it serves, for instance, to alarm the player to an upcoming event. This can be seen in many horror games like Doom 3 and Silent Hill.

Emotional functions

This is closely related to semiotic functions. This focuses on the functionality of music which affects player's state and creates intimacy. Music induces mood into the player and changes how the player is feeling. For example, in Limbo, a game in which game music is not present for most part of the game, serious music is played when the avatar has to face opponents to create a feeling of anxiety and tension in the player.

Narrative functions

In many cases, audio cues can help to situate the player in the game world, by giving various locales or levels, different musical themes. By listening to the music, the player will be able to identify their whereabouts. Music at the end of boss scenes similarly changes momentarily to let us know we have graduated to a new level, even if physically we remain in the same place in the game. Similarly, audio is often used to locate the player in the storyline, anchoring the player in terms of where/when/what they are.

Non-verbal sound can likewise reveal details about a character whether they are a friend or a foe; for instance, either by their musical accompaniment or by the accent/language/timbre of their voice and, voice-over narrations can let us access a character's thoughts and feelings.



Screen shot of Silent Hill